P2JW303000-6-A00100-16DDF61078D

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp ****** FRIDAY, OCTOBER 30, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVIII NO. 103 WSJ.com ★★★★ $5.00

DJIA 52342.56 ▼ 132.54 0.25% NASDAQ 26184.72 ▼ 1.4% STOXX 600 649.11 ▲ 0.8% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 14/32, yield 4.988% OIL $102.00 ▼ $0.78 GOLD $4,017.70 ▼ $19.70 EURO $1.1181 YEN 157.71

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **The U.S. economy grew** at a 3.4% annual rate in the third quarter, marking the fastest pace in a year, as business investment surged and consumers continued to spend at a healthy clip. **A1, A2**

◆ **Google's stock** suffered its worst day on record as investors confronted the reality that a company that has long been a dynamo faces painful tradeoffs from the AI transition. **A1**

◆ **The Alphabet unit's** woes contributed to a general slide in U.S. indexes, with the S&P 500 and Dow both falling 0.3% and the Nasdaq retreating 1.4%. **B9**

◆ **DoorDash announced** the acquisition of Instacart for $17 billion, giving it a key position in grocery delivery and a platform to compete with the likes of Walmart and Amazon. **A1**

◆ **Hackers plundered** an estimated $6.3 billion from Binance in the largest-ever cryptocurrency heist, forcing the exchange to suspend transactions. **B1**

◆ **Amazon Web Services** brought in $46 billion in revenue for the three months through September, accounting for 39% growth year over year. **B1**

◆ **Intel shares plunged** 22% in after-hours trading after the company reported disappointing third-quarter results and forecast a prolonged slowdown in PC sales. **B1**

◆ **Merck posted higher** revenue, pointing to the strength of drugs such as Keytruda and Winrevair, as well as its animal-health business. **B2**

◆ **ADT agreed** to be acquired for $7.6 billion in cash by Thrive Holdings, an investment vehicle of Josh Kushner's venture-capital firm. **B3**

Worldwide

◆ **Big tech companies** are quietly resisting the use of subpoenas to seek information from them about users critical of the Trump administrations's immigration policies. **A1**

◆ **The Trump administration** agreed to send around $35 million in aid to a Central African military unit accused of war crimes as part of an arrangement to deport third-country migrants to the region. **A3**

◆ **Early-voting turnout** has set records for a Georgia midterm so far, and top party surrogates are descending on the state. **A4**

◆ **The Trump administration** promised to ease tariffs on automakers that commit to more U.S. manufacturing, a policy change that emerged amid talks to get Audi to build a plant in Georgia. **A3**

◆ **Israeli Arab parties** won 19 seats in the Knesset, according to preliminary results, turning them into political power brokers. **A6**

◆ **Ukraine's military** paused its strikes against Russian oil refineries after weeks of pressure from Trump shook Kyiv's confidence in U.S. support. **A7**

◆ **Chinese leader Xi** Jinping is tightening his grip on the Communist Party as Beijing prepares for a key personnel shuffle next year that seems set to extend his rule. **A7**

◆ **Chronically ill people** on Medicaid won't be bound by new work-requirement rules drawn up by the Trump administration, a judge ruled. **A5**

◆ **Died: Patrick Stewart**, 86, acclaimed English actor. **A5** ... **Elke Sommer**, 85, star of "A Shot in the Dark." **A5**

CONTENTS

Arts in Review	A10-11
Business & Finance	B2
Business News	B3
Crossword	A11
Heard on Street	B10
Market Data	B6
Markets	B9
Opinion	A13-15
Money & Investing	B10
Sports	A12
Technology	B4
U.S. News	A2-5
World News	A6-8

© 2026 Dow Jones & Company, Inc. All Rights Reserved

U.S. Economy Grew 3.4% This Summer

Consumer spending, business investment powered the fastest expansion in a year

By Konrad Putzier

The U.S. economy grew at a 3.4% annual rate in the third quarter, marking the fastest pace in a year, as business investment surged and consumers continued to spend at a healthy clip.

The latest reading of gross domestic product—the value of all goods and services produced across the economy—beat analysts' expectations for a pace of 3.1%.

The report from the Commerce Department is the last major accounting of the U.S. economy before midterm elections on Tuesday. The numbers add to evidence that, despite tariffs, an immigration crackdown and high energy prices, the U.S. economy remains on solid footing.

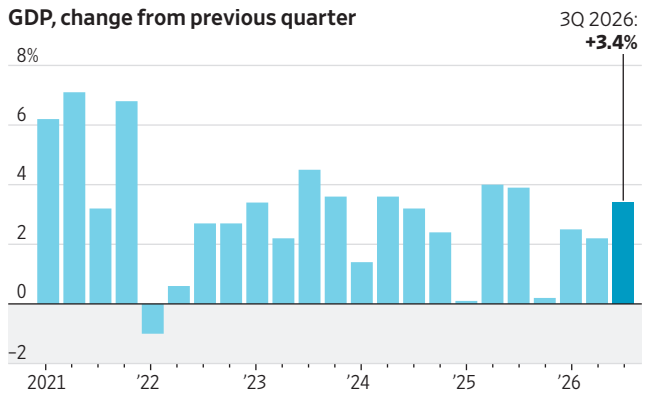
Higher business investment was driven by the artificial-intelligence build-out, while strong consumer spending came despite high gas prices and other affordability concerns. The 3.4% annual economic growth rate is adjusted for inflation and seasonality.

A separate report, also from the Commerce Department, found that the Federal Reserve's preferred measure of inflation accelerated in September.

Stocks fell slightly Thursday

Please turn to page A2

◆ **National debt reaches 100% of GDP..... A2**



Note: Seasonally and inflation-adjusted at annual rates
Source: Commerce Department

Lagarde to Step Down Early as ECB President



MATIAS BASUALDO/ZUMA PRESS

WINTER EXIT: Christine Lagarde, shown Thursday in Frankfurt, plans to depart in February, several months before her term as head of the European Central Bank was set to end. Europe's largest countries are already jockeying over who will succeed her. A8

Alphabet Loses Half A Trillion Dollars In Value

Google's stock suffered its worst day on record Thursday as investors confronted the reality that a company that has long been a dynamo of growth and profits faces painful tradeoffs from the artificial-intelligence transition.

*By **Hannah Erin Lang**, **Erin Woo** and **Suzanne Vranica***

The slide erased about $500 billion from Alphabet's market value, the second-biggest drop for any U.S. company on record. Google's 12% decline also weighed on major U.S. stock indexes, fueling a 1.4% decline in the Nasdaq composite and amplifying fears that the costs of the global AI build-out might be outrunning the returns.

The tech giant reported Wednesday that its Google Services unit, which includes search advertising, YouTube and subscriptions, generated $96.3 billion, missing Wall Street expectations of $98.5 billion and signaling that Google's biggest revenue engine is slowing as AI reshapes how consumers search for information and products. Google Search revenue grew 12% year over year in the third quarter, down from 17%

Please turn to page A9

◆ **Heard on the Street: Alphabet can still win.... B10**

Scandal Jolts Crucial Race in Alaska

By Lindsay Wise And Jennifer Hiller

ANCHORAGE—As winter set in and Election Day neared in Alaska, high prices for diesel and home heating oil drove voter anger at President Trump and incumbent Republican Sen. Dan S. Sullivan, making the Senate race in this red state one of the most competitive in the country.

Now, with just days to go, allegations that Democrat Mary Peltola's campaign secretly worked to recruit a spoiler candidate to help her party win the pivotal Alaska seat—and potentially retake control of the U.S. Senate—has become this midterm election's biggest October surprise.

For months, Republicans raged over the presence on the ballot of a retired teacher named Dan J. Sullivan Jr. who will appear as one of four finalists for the Senate seat held by Dan S. Sullivan, potentially confusing voters. President Trump, a Republican, directed the Justice Department last week to sue Alaska, seeking to delay the results if the incumbent narrowly loses.

Then the New York Times reported on Wednesday that staffers with Peltola's campaign had worked with people to recruit the other Sullivan as a spoiler in the race—a strategy that her campaign had long denied. The state's governor, Mike Dunleavy, a Republican, has ordered an investigation, as Trump amped up his attacks, calling for Peltola and the other Sullivan to be criminally prosecuted and tossed off the ballot.

The Justice Department on Thursday expanded its criminal investigation, sending dozens of new grand jury subpoenas, people familiar with the matter said.

America's Last Frontier already was a chaotic Senate battleground. Alaska is seen by both Republicans and Democrats as one of a handful of states needed to win control

Please turn to page A4

DoorDash to Purchase Instacart for $17 Billion

By Heather Haddon

DoorDash Chief Executive Tony Xu has cemented his company—and its army of nine million "dashers"—as the kings of gig delivery.

The company announced on Thursday the acquisition of Instacart for $17 billion, Xu's biggest bet in the company's 13-year history.

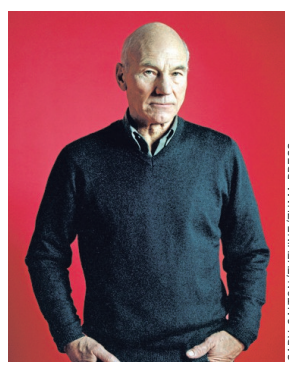
"The world's biggest companies are becoming larger," he said during an investor call. It was the right time to go on the offense, he said.

DoorDash—now a $78 billion company—has been expanding beyond restaurants to delivering dresses from Macy's, paper towels from Costco and cold medicine from CVS. The acquisition of Instacart gives DoorDash a key position in grocery delivery and a platform to compete with giants like Walmart and Amazon.

DoorDash said the deal values Instacart at $65 a share, an 11% premium to Wednesday's closing price and about 26% above Instacart's closing price on Oct. 22, before published reports that the com-

Please turn to page A5

INSIDE



GARY CALTON/EYEVINE/ZUMA PRESS

OBITUARY
Patrick Stewart, Shakespearean actor and Capt. Picard of 'Star Trek,' 86. **A5**

Tech Giants Resist ICE Data Requests

The Trump administration has stepped up its use of subpoenas to seek information from big technology companies about users critical of its immigration policies.

*By **Emily Glazer**, **Georgia Wells** and **Hannah Critchfield***

Now, with Democrats pushing to regain power in the midterm elections, Silicon Valley is boosting its quiet resistance.

Board members and top executives are trying to insulate their companies from potential Democratic-led congressional investigations and respond to user and employee concerns, while still placating the Trump administration, people familiar with the matter said. Executives anticipate Democrats will gain more power in Congress after the midterms, and some lawmakers are already asking why the companies handed over sensitive user information.

Meta Platforms and Alphabet's Google in recent months have taken steps including

Please turn to page A4

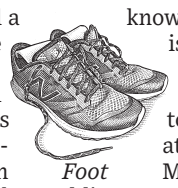
Your Humble Shoe Salesperson Might Be an Elite Marathoner

* * *

A handful of top runners fit customers who have no idea; 'That's 4:30 a mile!'

By Rachel Bachman

MINNEAPOLIS—A young woman came into Fleet Feet in Minneapolis with days before her first marathon and a big worry: Her knee had started hurting. As Joel Reichow pulled an assortment of shoes for her to try, he reassured her it's common to feel aches in the final training push.



Foot soldiers

"Sometimes during the taper, the body just kind of panics," he said.

What the woman didn't know was that Reichow isn't just another guy measuring her foot. Last year, he was the top American finisher at the New York City Marathon, fifth overall,

Please turn to page A12

Beleaguered Flash Chip Sellers Get Their Revenge on Apple

The iPhone maker for years bullied flash-storage makers into steep discounts—until AI hyperscalers bid up prices

By Rolfe Winkler

During a ride in a Southern California desert, sales executive Scott Nelson stopped his dirt bike, pulled out a rifle and shot his old iPod.

Nelson sold flash storage to Apple and hated feeling like he always got the worst end of the deal. His Japan-based manufacturer, Kioxia, had little leverage. Apple was the world's biggest buyer of flash—the chips in iPhones that store photos, music and apps—and used its position to squeeze every cent from suppliers. Apple bullied flash makers into opening their books so it could monitor sales, making sure no one else got a better deal.

Kioxia and other flash makers stewed as Apple paid them pennies for flash storage that the iPhone maker resold to customers for dollars. The disparity in bargaining power had galled Nelson, who used Android phones in protest.

Please turn to page A9